



Facebook's unit of time

Facebook launched a unit of time called "Flicks," which is 1/705600000 of a second. That's slightly longer than a nanosecond. <http://digit.in/FbFlicks>



Falcon Heavy test fires

SpaceX has successfully carried out a test fire for their Falcon Heavy rocket, scheduled to launch in early Feb. <http://digit.in/SpaceXFH>

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FUTURE FEATURE

"If only we could transport the technology back to Earth, we would be able to make more sales on different continents on our planet as well as Saturn and Jupiter. Plus finding investors for newer projects on Mars and Uranus would become easier", I whined to Frank.

The conversation steered towards the real estate crash on Neptune before my private view projection blinked on. It was time for us to return to the conference main hall for a face-to-face interaction with the industry gurus. One more press on the ring and we were back to the Travel Zone at the conference area.

The ticker on the floor led us to the conference hall where we were greeted by usher-bots who took us to our seats.

As the room turned dark, our attention was drawn to the screening bots in front of us. Ms. Nakamura, founder of the Commission and the force behind Saturn's lavish status appeared on the screen and the room erupted with a thundering applause for the woman who changed the landscape of an entire planet.

"40 years ago, when a company was formed with the objective to eventually colonise Mars, it started a period of revolution that we today know as the Aether Revolution," said Nakamura in her trademark sonorous and theatrical voice. "It kick-started a flurry of activity and a space race to who would colonise Mars first. Who colonised Mars is a topic best left untouched", there was scattered laughter at the mention of highly controversial debate that still raged today. "Whoever colonised it first, we, all of us in this room made it a home. It was our vision and our sweat that provided the base for the thriving economy and ecosystem that has developed today across planets."

"Nobody but her could have achieved this, you know" said Frank admirably.

"She is an unstoppable force. I can only wait to see what new project she takes up next", I replied, not quite able to hide my interest and curiosity about getting a glimpse of the much awaited super secret project announced last year.

"Oh you will see soon, I am sure", he said with a wink.

"And now, if all you would please accept the VR ring offered to you, I would like to show everyone my vision for the future", said Ms. Nakamura. There was a rustling as everybody took the ring offered by the robot and put it on. I took mine and imagined an army of nanobots marching at light speed from my ring finger to all sensory nodes of my brain telling me what I am feeling, hearing and seeing is real.

I couldn't believe what I saw. My brain told me this is just a vision, but another part of it couldn't wait for the day it would be real. The housing complex in front of me was unlike any I had ever seen before. No, not a housing complex, a complete self sustaining ecology of a spaceship, capable of sustaining 10 million humans! A travelling civilization, capable of visiting every single planet once in a month... this was groundbreaking!

So caught was I in my reverie that I nearly jumped out of my skin when Frank tapped me on the shoulder. "So

Mark, can I show you around", he asked with a genial laugh. I grinned sheepishly and not trusting my voice yet, motioned for him to start the tour. As we walked around the ship, he pointed out the various levels of Space City, as it was code-named at this point – residential and amenities levels, office and factory levels, etc.

I followed him around soaking it all in and he led me to the tallest building on the office level. RECPs, said the bright 3 dimensional flashing sign hovering over the building and running in a marquee around it at the base. Narcissism is universal, I thought, but they could be forgiven this extravaganza for creating the next big thing in real estate.

"Our new corporate head office", announced Mr. Gerbert with a touch of pride. "Nanobot supplemented carbon plates. Can last for a century. Go on, feel them". The building was indeed resilient yet warm to the touch, like wood.

"So how would you guys like to be associated with us on this?" Frank asked.

"Of course! That would be the perfect opportunity to deploy our proprietary enhanced VR system which will guarantee the sale of every square inch of this place in the shortest time possible. We have been laying low while developing this system, so we can make a big splash with the right project."

"Mark, you remind me of my younger self – ambitious, eager and always ready to push a sale. Come, let's get back now, we will talk details later". We pressed the ring again and found ourselves in a mostly empty hall as the speaker session had ended some time ago.

As we walked towards the trade show, I was still dazed and elated from the recent conversation. Me, a younger self of Frank Gerbert! I might actually get this contract! I still couldn't believe it. Play it cool, don't jump the gun now and ruin it all, I told myself.

As we neared the trade show, a screen popped up in front of us asking us to select the particular category of products we were interested in.

"I'm not sure whether I like or hate this new system. I remember the days when we had to walk to every stall and booth, just to find something you needed, and got a surprise every now and then. That was fun too" Frank reminisced.

"You can still select view all" I said politely while selecting the 3 categories my company recommended for me.

"Maybe later," said Frank.

We took a viewing chair each and the first category, Nanobot Enhanced Building Products was projected, complete with a good-looking, affable company representative.

"Welcome to the future..." the voice droned on as I switched off my operating system to take a much needed snooze and save my battery for the trip back to Earth. I could just watch this later. The first ever Earthie to land a deal selling real estate on the solar system's first ever travelling Space City. "I am going down in history for this". My last thought as the system shutdown completed was a famous Einstein quote, "Logic will get you from A to B. Imagination will take you everywhere." 